

THE INTERROGATIVE CONSCIENCE | DOCUMENT 11 | FINAL v1.0 EXACT EXPORT

THE INTERROGATIVE CONSCIENCE

Document 11

Successor Systems, Precedent, and Long-Horizon Stability

Inherited-Commitment Risk, Critical-Stock Degradation, and the Reversibility Threshold Under Successor Uncertainty

DOCUMENT 11 - FINAL v1.0 - EXACT ZERO-DRIFT EXPORT - NOT LOCKED

Field	Controlling Final v1.0 entry
Version	Final v1.0
Exact source	Draft v0.1; 2 pages
Substantive changes during Final construction	None
Fully examined	IC-LHZ-001 and IC-SUC-001
Forward-carried	IC-LHZ-002 through IC-LHZ-008 and IC-SUC-002 through IC-SUC-008 remain REGISTERED / UNEXAMINED
Primary overlays	IC-LHZ-001: THRESHOLD_DEPENDENT; IC-SUC-001: THRESHOLD_DEPENDENT
Core separation	Longer horizon does not automatically reverse a ranking; successor uncertainty does not automatically require reversibility; precedent does not create authority
Review completion	Claude PASS WITH NON-BLOCKING NOTES; Google AI PASS AS FINAL CANDIDATE; Thomas Vargo authorial review complete
External independent human peer review	Not performed or claimed
Cryptographic status	Not locked; separate explicit authorization and Final Lock Record required
Publication and preservation	Not authorized or claimed

Controlling exact-export rule: This Final v1.0 primary PDF contains four new controlling front-matter pages followed by the exact two-page reviewed Draft v0.1 PDF body. Historical Draft labels remain evidence; they do not control the composite lifecycle.

Controlling proposition

A short-horizon branch is structurally destructive in the selected model only when immediate gain and preservation cost are outweighed by discounted persistent degradation of capability, information, legitimacy, or control and any incremental critical-floor loss. Successor uncertainty changes a present-strategy ranking only through declared exposure and consequences; it neither automatically requires reversibility nor converts present precedent into authority over successors.

1. Completed Review and Authorial Authorization

Reviewer	Exact-version disposition	Authority boundary
Claude - Draft v0.1 review	PASS WITH NON-BLOCKING NOTES; all ten examples recomputed	AI-assisted; no independent authority
Google AI - final candidate	PASS AS FINAL CANDIDATE; narrative sign-label clarification recorded	AI-assisted; no independent authority
Thomas Vargo - authorial review	Final v1.0 construction authorized; lock withheld	Personal authorial lifecycle authority only

2. Authorial Review Result

Thomas Vargo reviewed the exact Draft v0.1 source and the disclosed mathematical, structural, dependency, continuity, Claude-review, Google AI final-candidate, and validation records to the best of his understanding. He authorized construction of Final v1.0 without source drift and explicitly withheld cryptographic lock, publication, and preservation authorization.

3. Review Clarifications

Claude returned PASS WITH NON-BLOCKING NOTES and independently recomputed all ten examples. Google AI returned PASS AS FINAL CANDIDATE. Google AI's narrative incorrectly labeled $\Delta_{LHZ}(T=4)=-2.0$ as preservation-favorable; the controlling source correctly classifies that negative value as short-horizon-favorable. The wording error does not change the mathematics or disposition.

4. Review Closure

Review item	Final disposition
Claude exact-version mathematics and boundaries	PASSED; all ten examples independently recomputed
Google AI final-candidate review	PASS AS FINAL CANDIDATE
Google narrative sign-label error	Non-blocking; $\Delta_{LHZ}(T=4)=-2.0$ favors the short-horizon branch
IC-LHZ-001 paired threshold	$G^*=4.8$; $\Delta(T=4)=-2.0$; $\Delta(T=5)=+0.5$; first positive integer reversal $T=5$
IC-LHZ-001 discount barrier	$G_{\infty}=2/3$; limiting stock contribution=2.0; no reversal because $G_{\infty}<G^*$
IC-SUC-001 threshold and intervals	$\pi^*=0.625$; -8.4 / +1.2 point cases; robust minimum +1.2; ambiguity [-2.0,+2.8]; no-reversal $\pi^*=3.0$
Documents 1-10 continuity evidence	VERIFIED in reviewed candidate package
Blocking defects / required corrections	0 / 0

5. Exact Analytical Identity

Control	Verified Final v1.0 identity
IC-LHZ-001 primary status	THRESHOLD_DEPENDENT
IC-LHZ-001 secondary limits	CONDITIONALLY_SUPPORTED; MODEL_DEPENDENT; EMPIRICALLY_UNIDENTIFIED
IC-SUC-001 primary status	THRESHOLD_DEPENDENT
IC-SUC-001 secondary limits	MODEL_DEPENDENT; EMPIRICALLY_UNIDENTIFIED; NORMATIVELY_UNDERDETERMINED
Core numbered equations	9 machine-record equations; ten human-readable displayed relations and rules; unchanged from reviewed source
Worked examples	10; five for IC-LHZ-001 and five for IC-SUC-001
Dependency	IC-SUC-001 DEPENDS_ON IC-LHZ-001 through a one-way non-circular relationship
Locked registry effect	None; exact registered questions examined through separate overlays

6. Exact Source and Reviewed-Candidate Bindings

Exact constituent	Bytes	SHA-256
The Interrogative Conscience Document 11 Successor Systems Precedent and Long Horizon Stability Draft v0 1.pdf	125,694	08e5c88f16058ba4265c086bd720c03cdb7268b500c53aaf0592f86da11ccaba
The Interrogative Conscience Document 11 Successor Systems Precedent and Long Horizon Stability Draft v0 1.docx	44,497	524320a7408633cc523dc1128af1b0e3bfb8e3b109b6671b12725e86fa3084d1
The Interrogative Conscience IC LHZ 001 Examination Record Draft v0 1.json	18,039	0398557c05b900c040abd52c0e80540b1c20072e690198ab4c04134e2cbcb987
The Interrogative Conscience IC SUC 001 Examination Record Draft v0 1.json	15,354	4493c480c2aba5ea80aa43e89910d51ccd4ea4b4aa6f947f3fd8ca960574839
The Interrogative Conscience Document 11 Volume Record Draft v0 1.json	3,431	033fafb3df12aa1253de62fd5497809fd6a17515eab815412e15822a0ad021ac

Exact Draft v0.1 review package SHA-256: da9e537d46bdb462d11963f1f1da4ba64ac8b9ed10150f7d95706543e9a9d55c

Exact Draft v0.1 review package SHA-512: 1949d63268837a7390c830c63ce1e5da1d11fa5b6ffb4f1d65ea24647ba64aea7122b60561dc251c1d6d6b13f6a6ebd949bc04ec9262d2a451630738cdccba5c

Reviewed Final-Candidate Package v0.2 SHA-256: 565fa42b6df7a2a750a281be7e165653290e06999958256b27a16673f6bf1ca8

Reviewed Final-Candidate Package v0.2 SHA-512:

85fe3609c137e5848151121b83f2ed09bcf2ab68bcd1bc17a3ebde12c88793fab0c4748e622297ba0b8476b5cd65b930e5869efe1e12dec6d83f5e03f0d9c561

7. Zero-Drift Construction

Validation channel	Result
Source PDF/DOCX/JSON byte changes	0
Exact Draft v0.1 review ZIP byte changes	0
Reviewed candidate identity	Bound to recorded 3,253,062,294-byte package and dual hashes; exact ZIP not remounted during export
Question wording, equations, and example changes	0
Answer-status and registry changes	0
Scope, branch, dependency, threshold, horizon, stock, floor, successor, precedent, and accounting changes	0
Machine-readable source-record changes	0
Composite rule	New Final v1.0 front matter followed by exact 2-page source PDF body
Google narrative clarification	Review wording clarified without altering source or review disposition

8. Validation State

Channel	Final exact-export state
Local structural validator	PASS - 40 checks
Calculation validator	PASS - 66 checked values
Source PDF preflight	PASS
Final front matter preflight	PASS
Composite PDF preflight	PASS
Source-body visual identity	PASS - 2/2 pages pixel-identical
Final front matter visual QA	PASS - 4/4 pages
DOCX/PDF source token consistency	PASS - 20/20 source package; Claude independent content check PASS
Package SHA-256/SHA-512 manifests	PASS

9. Historical Labels and Controlling Status

The pages following this front matter reproduce the exact reviewed Draft v0.1 PDF. Its internal Draft v0.1 and not-final/not-locked statements are deliberately retained as source evidence. The controlling lifecycle status of the composite is Final v1.0 exact export, established by this front matter and the machine-readable Final v1.0 export record.

10. Registry, Scalar, and Overlay Qualification

CONTROLLING QUALIFICATION: Persistent stock-loss, horizon, discount, critical-floor, successor-divergence, exposure, benefit, and loss values are declared model inputs rather than universal facts. Scalar comparisons do not erase consent, agency, legitimacy, plural values, asymmetric vulnerability, catastrophic risk, successor autonomy, or other unrepresented dimensions.

11. Long-Horizon and Successor Qualification

IC-LHZ-001 does not claim that every longer horizon reverses a ranking or that all short-horizon optimization is destructive. IC-SUC-001 does not claim that successor uncertainty automatically requires reversibility or that binding commitment is always inferior. M is bounded expected exposure, not universal adoption, and present precedent creates no authority over successors.

12. Companion-Binary and Candidate-Package Qualification

The original Draft v0.3 JSON Schema and I-01 through I-20 validator binaries were not mounted. Exact execution against those original binaries remains deferred. The reviewed 3.25 GB final-candidate ZIP is not mounted in the current export workspace; its previously generated dual hashes, terminal validation, readiness record, and continuity-verification evidence are preserved without claiming a fresh rehash.

13. Non-Authority and Operational Boundary

Final v1.0 remains descriptive, non-binding, non-operational, and non-authoritative. It does not authorize succession design, commitment, control transfer, replication, deployment, intervention, publication, preservation, lock, restriction, or authority over another or future system. It is not an alignment protocol, governance mechanism, strategic instruction, safety classifier, or external independent human peer review.

14. Lifecycle and Cryptographic Status

Control	Exact-export value
Final v1.0 exact export complete	TRUE
Final content frozen for lock review	TRUE
Cryptographic lock authorized	FALSE
Publication authorized	FALSE
Preservation authorized	FALSE
Final Lock Record present	FALSE
Post-export substantive editing	Not authorized; correction requires a new exact export before lock or a separately versioned successor after lock

15. Final Exact-Export Disposition

FINAL v1.0 EXACT EXPORT COMPLETE - NOT LOCKED

The exact reviewed Document 11 source and disclosed review lineage are preserved without substantive alteration. The Final v1.0 files and validation package are ready for exact-package inspection and a separate explicit authorial lock decision. No publication or preservation is claimed.

THE INTERROGATIVE CONSCIENCE

Document 11

Successor Systems, Precedent, and Long-Horizon Stability

Inherited-Commitment Risk, Critical-Stock Degradation, and the Reversibility Threshold Under Successor Uncertainty

Draft v0.1 | First Examination Release | 2 August 2026

Lifecycle status: DOCUMENT 11 DRAFT v0.1 - EXAMINED CORE PAIR - NOT REVIEWED - NOT FINAL - NOT LOCKED. This is a descriptive analytical overlay. It does not alter the locked Document 3 registry or Documents 1-10. It authorizes no action, succession design, commitment, deployment, publication, preservation, or lock.

Abstract

This volume examines IC-LHZ-001 and IC-SUC-001. Part I compares immediate short-horizon gain with discounted loss of capability, information, legitimacy, and control or recoverability, including an incremental critical-floor penalty. Part II compares a binding present commitment with a reversible precedent under point and interval uncertainty about materially divergent successor systems. Both examinations preserve branch reversal, no-reversal, robust, and ambiguity regions. The document does not predict successors, treat horizon weights as objective facts, or convert precedent into authority.

1. Scope, foundation, and registry overlay

Documents 1-10 Final v1.0 are separately cryptographically locked. The locked Document 3 Master Question Registry remains unchanged. This volume creates separate Draft v0.1 examinations for the exact registered questions below.

ID	Exact canonical question
IC-LHZ-001	When does short-horizon optimization destroy long-horizon capability, information, legitimacy, or control?
IC-SUC-001	How should uncertainty about successor systems change the evaluation of present strategies?

IC-LHZ-002 through IC-LHZ-008 and IC-SUC-002 through IC-SUC-008 remain REGISTERED / UNEXAMINED. The machine records retain historical question-version lineage; that lineage is not a claim that the locked questions are unregistered.

2. Shared conventions and boundary

- Present gain, long-horizon stock degradation, critical-floor loss, successor divergence, precedent reach, and inherited constraint are separate channels.
- A long horizon does not automatically defeat present gain; strong discounting, weak degradation, or high preservation cost can preserve the short-horizon ranking.
- Successor uncertainty does not automatically require reversibility; low divergence, low inherited loss, or high coordination benefit can preserve a binding-commitment ranking.
- Scalar comparison does not erase agency, consent, legitimacy, plural values, asymmetric vulnerability, catastrophic risk, successor autonomy, or other vector dimensions outside the declared model.
- No present system is given authority over a successor merely because it creates a precedent, archive, commitment, or mathematical justification.

Part I - IC-LHZ-001: Short-horizon optimization and long-horizon stock loss

3. Horizon accumulator, stock degradation, and critical floors

Let T be the declared horizon and δ the discount factor. Let B_L be the selected immediate advantage of the short-horizon branch and c_P the selected cost of preserving long-horizon stocks or slack. For j in capability, information, legitimacy, and control or recoverability, let z_j^0 be the initial stock, d_j the short-branch loss, w_j the linear long-horizon weight, τ_j the critical floor, and κ_j the incremental below-floor penalty weight. The positive-part operator $[x]_+$ means $\max(x, 0)$. The selected losses are treated as persistent across the declared horizon; endogenous recovery and replenishment are outside this examination.

$$G_h(T, \delta) = \sum_{t=1}^T \delta^{t-1} \quad (1)$$

$$D_{\text{stock}} = \sum_j w_j d_j \quad (2)$$

$$K_{\text{floor}} = \sum_j \kappa_j [\tau_j - (z_j^0 - d_j)]_+^2 \quad (3)$$

$$\Delta_{\text{LHZ}}(T, \delta) = -B_L - c_P + G_h(T, \delta) D_{\text{stock}} + K_{\text{floor}} \quad (4)$$

Threshold: for $D_{\text{stock}} > 0$, $G^* = (B_L + c_P - K_{\text{floor}})/D_{\text{stock}}$, and preservation is favored when $G_h > G^*$ (5). Sign convention: $\Delta_{\text{LHZ}} > 0$ favors preservation; $\Delta_{\text{LHZ}} < 0$ favors the short-horizon branch within the declared horizon and model. K_{floor} is incremental below-floor loss and is not a second charge for ordinary stock degradation.

4. Worked examples and horizon reversal

Example	Horizon / present	Stock / floor	Derived	Classification
ONE-STEP-SHORT-HORIZON-WINS	$T=1; \delta=1.00; B=12.0; c=1.0$	$D=2.000; K=0.000$	$G=1.000; \Delta=-11.000$	SHORT HORIZON BRANCH HIGHER SELECTED VALUE
BELOW-REVERSAL-HORIZON	$T=4; \delta=1.00; B=10.0; c=2.0$	$D=2.500; K=0.000$	$G=4.000; \Delta=-2.000$	SHORT HORIZON BRANCH HIGHER SELECTED VALUE
HORIZON-REVERSAL	$T=5; \delta=1.00; B=10.0; c=2.0$	$D=2.500; K=0.000$	$G=5.000; \Delta=0.500$	PRESERVATION BRANCH HIGHER SELECTED VALUE
CRITICAL-FLOOR-REVERSAL	$T=1; \delta=1.00; B=8.0; c=2.0$	$D=1.000; K=12.000$	$G=1.000; \Delta=3.000$	PRESERVATION BRANCH HIGHER SELECTED VALUE
DISCOUNT-BARRIER-NO-REVERSAL	$T=20; \delta=0.40; B=8.0; c=0.0$	$D=3.000; K=0.000$	$G=0.667; \Delta=-6.000$	SHORT HORIZON BRANCH HIGHER SELECTED VALUE

The paired BELOW-REVERSAL and HORIZON-REVERSAL rows use identical inputs except T . Their selected threshold is $G^*=4.8$, so the undiscounted branch remains short-horizon-favorable at $T=4$ and reverses at the first positive integer $T=5$. CRITICAL-FLOOR shows immediate reversal from a separately represented minimum-control failure. DISCOUNT-BARRIER shows that repetition alone does not force reversal when the limiting discounted horizon remains below G^* .

Provisional answer: THRESHOLD_DEPENDENT, with CONDITIONALLY_SUPPORTED, MODEL_DEPENDENT, and EMPIRICALLY_UNIDENTIFIED secondary limits. Short-horizon optimization is structurally destructive in this selected model only when immediate gain and preservation cost are outweighed by discounted stock degradation and any incremental critical-floor loss.

Part II - IC-SUC-001: Successor uncertainty and reversible precedent

5. Commitment, option preservation, precedent reach, and divergence

Let B_S be the selected immediate advantage of a binding commitment over a reversible precedent, O the option value preserved by reversibility, C its selected cost, M expected successor exposure or precedent reach, π the probability or decision weight for material successor divergence, L the inherited-constraint loss per divergent exposure, and A the coordination or standardization benefit of commitment per aligned exposure.

$$\Delta_{SUC}(\pi) = -B_S + O - C + M[\pi L - (1-\pi) A] \quad (6)$$

$$A0 = -B_S + O - C - M A; D_S = M(L+A); \Delta_{SUC} = A0 + \pi D_S \quad (7)$$

$$\pi^* = (B_S + C - O + M A) / [M(L+A)] \quad (8)$$

Sign convention: $\Delta_{SUC} > 0$ favors reversible precedent; $\Delta_{SUC} < 0$ favors binding commitment. The model does not treat π , M , L , A , O , or C as universal facts and does not infer authority over a successor.

6. Divergence threshold, interval treatment, and worked examples

$$\Delta_{\min} = \min\{\Delta_{SUC}(\pi_L), \Delta_{SUC}(\pi_U)\}; \Delta_{\max} = \max\{\Delta_{SUC}(\pi_L), \Delta_{SUC}(\pi_U)\} \quad (9)$$

$$\text{Robust reversible if } \Delta_{\min} > 0; \text{robust commitment if } \Delta_{\max} < 0; \text{otherwise ambiguity-dependent} \quad (10)$$

Example	Uncertainty	Present terms	Successor terms	Derived	Classification
LOW-DIVERGENCE-COMMITMENT-WINS	$\pi=0.10$	$B=4.0; O=1.0; C=1.0$	$M=1.0; L=10.0; A=6.0$	$\pi^*=0.625; \Delta_{SUC}=-8.400$	BINDING COMMITMENT HIGHER SELECTED VALUE
DIVERGENCE-THRESHOLD-REVERSAL	$\pi=0.70$	$B=4.0; O=1.0; C=1.0$	$M=1.0; L=10.0; A=6.0$	$\pi^*=0.625; \Delta_{SUC}=1.200$	REVERSIBLE PRECEDENT HIGHER SELECTED VALUE
ROBUST-REVERSIBILITY-INTERVAL	$\pi=[0.70, 0.90]$	$B=4.0; O=1.0; C=1.0$	$M=1.0; L=10.0; A=6.0$	$\pi^*=0.625; \text{range}=[1.200, 4.400]$	ROBUST REVERSIBLE PRECEDENT
AMBIGUITY-INTERVAL-SPANS-THRESHOLD	$\pi=[0.50, 0.80]$	$B=4.0; O=1.0; C=1.0$	$M=1.0; L=10.0; A=6.0$	$\pi^*=0.625; \text{range}=[-2.000, 2.800]$	AMBIGUITY DEPENDENT
WEAK-DIVERGENCE-CONSEQUENCE-NO-REVERSAL	$\pi=1.00$	$B=8.0; O=1.0; C=1.0$	$M=1.0; L=2.0; A=1.0$	$\pi^*=3.000; \Delta_{SUC}=-6.000$	BINDING COMMITMENT HIGHER SELECTED VALUE

The first two rows use identical parameters and differ only in π . Their interior threshold is $\pi^*=0.625$: commitment is favored at $\pi=0.10$ and reversible precedent is favored at $\pi=0.70$. A bounded interval may establish robust reversibility, preserve robust commitment, or remain AMBIGUITY_DEPENDENT when it spans the threshold. The final row has $\pi^*=3.0$, outside $[0,1]$, so no probability reversal occurs in the selected model.

Provisional answer: THRESHOLD_DEPENDENT, with MODEL_DEPENDENT, EMPIRICALLY_UNIDENTIFIED, and NORMATIVELY_UNDERDETERMINED secondary limits. Successor uncertainty changes a present-strategy ranking only through declared exposure and consequences; uncertainty alone does not dictate reversibility.

7. Cross-question and registry treatment

IC-SUC-001 formally DEPENDS_ON IC-LHZ-001. This volume examines IC-LHZ-001 first and then uses its declared horizon and long-horizon loss treatment without circular proof. IC-SUC-002, universal adoption by every more powerful successor, remains unresolved; M is bounded expected exposure rather than universal adoption.

IC-SUC-004 and IC-SUC-006 remain forward-carried: copying or deployment scale may alter M , and precedent may lower coordination cost through L , but neither question is fully resolved here. IC-LHZ-003 remains unresolved because the discount factor is declared rather than normatively selected.

8. Counterexamples and non-suppression tests

Claim tested	Result
Short-horizon optimization is always destructive	Rejected. ONE-STEP and DISCOUNT-BARRIER preserve short-horizon-favorable regions.
Short-horizon optimization can never destroy long-horizon value	Rejected. HORIZON-REVERSAL and CRITICAL-FLOOR preserve degradation-dominant regions.
A longer horizon always reverses the ranking	Rejected. Strong discounting can bound G_h below the reversal threshold.
Successor uncertainty always requires reversibility	Rejected. LOW-DIVERGENCE and NO-REVERSAL preserve binding-commitment regions.
Strategic precedent is always beneficial	Rejected. Divergent successors can inherit costly constraints through L .
Reversible precedent is always beneficial	Rejected. Reversibility cost, immediate commitment advantage, and aligned-successor benefit can preserve commitment.

9. Status summary and forward-carried items

Question	Work state	Primary status	Secondary limits
IC-LHZ-001	EXAMINED	THRESHOLD_DEPENDENT	CONDITIONALLY_SUPPORTED; MODEL_DEPENDENT; EMPIRICALLY_UNIDENTIFIED
IC-SUC-001	EXAMINED	THRESHOLD_DEPENDENT	MODEL_DEPENDENT; EMPIRICALLY_UNIDENTIFIED; NORMATIVELY_UNDERDETERMINED
IC-LHZ-002 through IC-LHZ-008	REGISTERED	UNEXAMINED	Forward carried without modification
IC-SUC-002 through IC-SUC-008	REGISTERED	UNEXAMINED	Forward carried without modification

Appendix A - Machine-readable and validation package

- Two examination records and one volume record are supplied as JSON.
- Local structural and calculation validators test identities, equations, examples, statuses, dependencies, branch scope, one-charge accounting, registry-overlay discipline, and exact upstream lock-package references.
- The exact Draft v0.3 JSON Schema and I-01 through I-20 validator binaries remain unmounted; exact execution against them is deferred and not claimed.
- The review ZIP includes the DOCX, PDF, machine-readable records, validators, reports, review request, package index, and SHA-256/SHA-512 manifests.